

ACHIEVE! HISTORY



CHINA 1

The ancient world

Rachel Towns



Made for the
Australian Curriculum



Achieve! History

Features

- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills
- ✓ Emphasis on understanding essential History content
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes, providing clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities
- ✓ CD-ROM containing all the pages from the book that can be used on the Interactive Whiteboard
- ✓ Word documents of all work sheets that can be edited to suit the individual needs of students
- ✓ Illustration files that can be added to new teacher-created work sheets

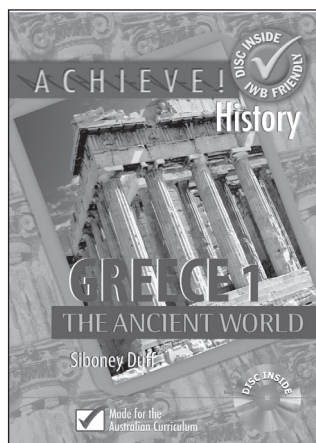
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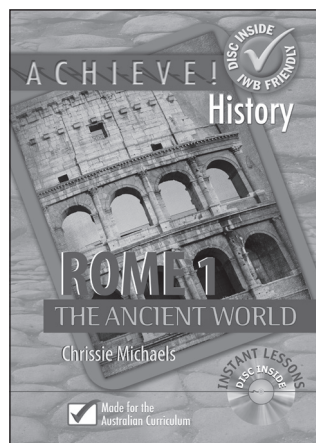
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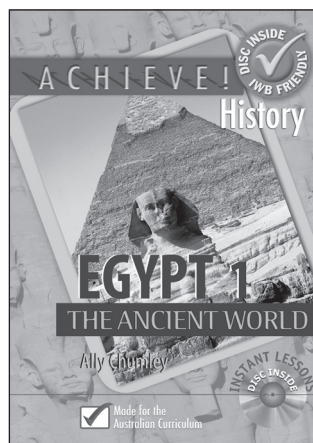
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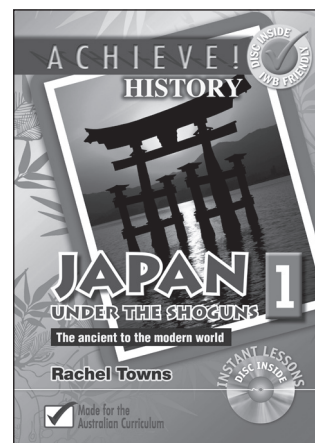
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ACHIEVE!
HISTORY

CHINA 1

The ancient world

Rachel Towns

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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

The ancient world: China 1 looks at the experiences of the ancient Chinese by exploring their occupations, lifestyles and family structures as well as law and order. Content also includes information about war and conflict, the life of Emperor Qin Shi Huang, women's lives, religion and trade. This text also provides students with an understanding of the importance of geography and land use in the development of the Chinese civilisation. Historical and literacy skills are developed through the analysis of images and information, organising information in appropriate sections and becoming familiar with time periods and primary and secondary sources.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, containing photocopiable Resource sheets and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity work sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the students.

Extension ideas – Additional tasks are suggested to recap the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, or to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

The Australian Curriculum alignment	Unit									
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
The physical features of China (such as the Yellow River) and how they influenced the civilisation that developed there (ACDSEH005)	✓	✓							✓	
Roles of key groups in Chinese society in this period (such as kings, emperors, scholars, craftsmen, women), including the influence of law and religion (ACDSEH041)	✓		✓	✓		✓		✓		
The significant beliefs, values and practices of Chinese society, with a particular emphasis on ONE of the following areas: everyday life, warfare, or death and funerary customs (ACDSEH042)					✓		✓	✓		✓
Contacts and conflicts within and/or with other societies, resulting in developments such as the expansion of trade, the rise of Imperial China (including its material remains), and the spread of philosophies and beliefs (ACDSEH043)							✓	✓	✓	
The role of a significant individual in ancient Chinese history such as Confucius or Qin Shi Huang (ACDSEH132)				✓						✓

Objectives

- Identify important historical features of ancient China
- Recognise the difference between primary and secondary sources
- Identify recognised historical periods for ancient China

Prior knowledge

Students should have some basic map-reading skills and be able to identify Australia in an atlas.

Background

Ancient China covers a long period of history, spanning several dynasties. China differed greatly from one dynasty to another. This unit aims to clarify the historical time periods of ancient China, as well as introducing important features, such as emperors and dynasties. This unit also introduces the terms BC/AD and BCE/CE, timelines and primary and secondary sources, as students will need to be familiar with these terms when undertaking further historical study.

Starter activity

Hold a class brainstorm to find out what students know about ancient China. Encourage students to come up with ideas without worrying about whether they are right or wrong. You may wish to give each student a whiteboard marker so they can write their idea on the board, or you may ask them to come up with ideas in small groups and then share them with the class. After you have talked through their responses, ask the students where they got their ideas from. Prompt them to discuss the internet, movies, books, cartoons and anything else they may have gathered information from. Ask them to be specific about which sources they have found the most useful and why.

Resource and Activity sheets

As a class, read through the Activity sheet, 'Ancient China'. Ask the students to identify any words that they do not understand and provide definitions for students to write in their workbooks. Working out the distance from China to Australia could be done as a class. The aim of this work sheet is to give students a geographic understanding of China, as well as an introduction to ancient China.

The Activity sheet, 'Ruling families', consolidates the information about emperors and dynasties from the 'Ancient China' Resource sheet, as well as explaining the variety of spellings used when Chinese names are written in English. The areas of interest should be shared in class to find common ground. This could also help with directing class topics or external research projects.

The Resource sheet, 'Recording time', should be read before completing the Activity sheet, 'Timeline', to ensure that students understand the difference between BC/AD and BCE/CE. This is very important when studying ancient China, as dates may refer to BC/BCE events or AD/CE events.

The Activity sheet, 'Primary and secondary sources', explains the difference between these two sources of information, as well as demonstrating why both are important.

Extension ideas

- Students could compare the size of China to their own country, then list reasons why the size might have made it difficult for the emperors to maintain control.
- The ancient Chinese mostly travelled over land on foot or by camel, horseback or carriage and over water on ships and boats. Students could measure the distance from one end of China to the other and work out which forms of transport they would use. Students could also consider how the forms of transport might be different if they were rich or poor.
- Students could measure how long it takes them to walk one kilometre and then work out how long it would take them to walk to different locations in China: from one city to another and from one end to another.

Ancient China

When China was first settled, almost 4000 years ago, it was made up of many little **kingdoms**, each with its own ruler. This meant that for many years, nobody controlled all of China.

The kings who ruled the kingdoms often fought to become more powerful and to own more land. In the end, the most powerful king controlled the whole country and became known as the **emperor** of China. The Chinese believed that emperors were the 'sons of heaven', who had been chosen by the gods to rule.

The position of emperor was usually handed down to the eldest son or nearest male relative. When China was ruled by the same family for a long period of time, this period was called a **dynasty**. Each dynasty was named after the family who ruled during that time.

The ancient Chinese believed that their land was the centre of the universe. They called their country 'The Middle Kingdom'.

-  **1** Find Australia on the map below and colour it in. Now find China and colour it in, using a different colour.



- 2** How far is Australia from China? (Hint: Use a ruler or string to help you measure.)

Ruling families

The dynasties, or families, of ruling emperors were very powerful. They controlled the rest of the country and could tell people where to live or how to behave. If people disobeyed the emperor, they could be punished very severely.

The names of some dynasties can be spelt in many different ways in English. When Europeans first went to China they wanted to write down the Chinese names using the European alphabet. It was hard to get the sounds exactly right, so some names were spelt in different ways. For example, the Xia Dynasty is also referred to as the Hsia Dynasty. In Chinese there is only one way of writing and saying this name.

Hint: Try saying Xia and Hsia out loud, or Zhou and Chou. Each pair sounds almost the same.



Circle the correct answer.

- 1 The ruling families of ancient China were called: (dynasties / movements / the mafia / the Simpsons).
- 2 The names of dynasties are often spelt in different ways because (elephants / Europeans / Americans / Australians) had trouble writing down some Chinese words using the European alphabet.
- 3 The emperors were the sort of people who:
 - were very friendly to everyone.
 - controlled the way people acted and would punish anyone who didn't obey.
 - had parties on Saturdays and invited everyone to come.
- 4 What would you like to know about ancient China? Write down at least three questions.

Recording time

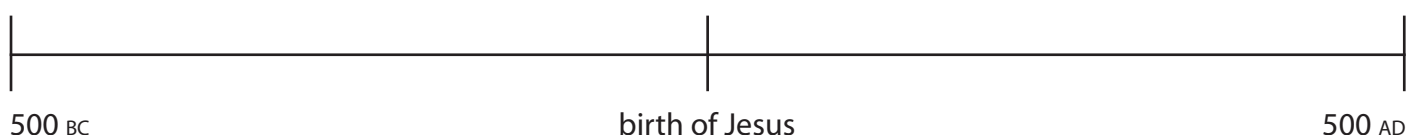
Most religions base their calendar around important people or events in their religion. The Christian calendar is dated from the birth of Jesus. The term BC, or 'Before Christ', is used to refer to events that happened before his birth, and AD, or 'Anno Domini' ('the year of our Lord'), refers to events that occurred after his birth. This makes it easier to work out when events happened in history.

Not everyone uses the Christian calendar. The year 2012 is the year 5772 for Jews and the year 1433 for Muslims. The term BCE, or 'Before Common Era', is sometimes used instead of 'Before Christ', and CE, or 'Common Era', is sometimes used instead of 'Anno Domini'.

 **1** Use these terms to fill in the table: BC, BCE, AD, CE.

Term	Definition
	This refers to the time before Jesus Christ was born.
	This stands for the Latin term 'Anno Domini', which means 'the year of our Lord', referring to the year Jesus Christ was born.
	This means 'before common era' and refers to the same time period as BC.
	This means 'common era' and refers to the same time period as AD.

2 Mark the terms BCE (Before Common Era) and CE (Common Era) in the correct places on the timeline.



3 Explain who would use the terms BC and AD.

4 Why do you think the terms BCE and CE are also used now?

Ancient China covers around 2800 years of history, from the Xia/Hsia Dynasty, which started in 2205 BCE, to the Sui Dynasty, which ended in 618 CE.

 1 Mark the dates and dynasties listed above on the timeline.

Please note: It wasn't always clear who was ruling China. This timeline only shows the families (or dynasties) who ruled. Sometimes individuals ruled for short periods of time, or two dynasties claimed the throne at the same time.

Primary and secondary sources

Information about history can come from both **primary** and **secondary sources**.

Source	Definition	Examples	Advantages	Disadvantages
Primary sources	Items that were written or made <u>during</u> the time	Pottery, diaries, scrolls, laws, newspapers, sculptures, photographs	• Written or made by people living during the time period • Gives specific information	• Could be biased by the person's attitude • The author may not understand the event themselves
Secondary sources	Items that were written or made <u>after</u> the time, using information from primary sources	Textbooks, newspapers, magazines, reconstructions, models	• Easy to find • Easy to understand • Gives general information	• May be incomplete or based on little research • Could be biased

Bias – believing one thing is better or worse than all others. For example, I like history, so my bias means I think it is better than all other subjects.

 **1** What things are you biased about (either towards or against)?

2 Label each of the following sources as a primary or secondary source.

Source 1

Huangti (Yellow God) was the son of Shaotien ... Born a genius he could speak when a baby, as a boy he was quick and smart, as a youth simple and earnest, and when grown up intelligent.

Sima Qian/Ssuma Ch'ien (145 BCE–86 BCE)

_____ source

Source 2

The ancient Chinese believed that their land was the centre of the universe.

Achieve! History – The ancient world: China 1, 2014 CE

_____ source

Objectives

- To use basic mapping skills (including BOLTSS) and to gain an understanding of the features landforms of ancient China
- To identify the importance of rivers and irrigation to the ancient Chinese civilisation
- For students to compare their lives to those of the Chinese people living in ancient China

Prior knowledge

Students should have some basic map-reading skills and be able to locate China on a map.

Background

The geography of China shaped some Chinese attitudes towards the outside world. It is a large country, bordered by a sea on one side and a large mountain range on the other. The ancient Chinese belief that foreigners were barbarians developed largely because they had so little contact with other countries and cultures. In the early years of civilisation, China was made up of many small kingdoms. Each one was valuable in some way: one area might have iron ore deposits, another access to a river, another good farmland. It was difficult to travel and trade with other civilisations. Instead, the kingdoms would trade with each other.

The lack of available fuel for fires in ancient China meant that food needed to be cooked quickly. This led to a tendency to cut food into small pieces and cook it in a wok, which in turn influenced Chinese utensils – the pieces of food were so small, they could be eaten with just chopsticks.

Starter activity

Discuss the importance of climate. What is the weather like in Australia? What about in the students' local area?

How does this affect the things they can do? Think about clothing, heating, food and activities. Compare this to other countries that students are familiar with. How would their behaviour change if they lived in another place with a very different climate?

Resource and Activity sheets

As a class, read through the 'Map skills' Activity sheet and discuss why students need to include BOLTSS in any map that they produce. This could lead to a small extension activity for the class where they map their classroom as a group.

The 'Land and climate' Resource sheet introduces the different types of areas – tropical, desert and mountainous – and their different features.

Students then use this information to complete the Activity sheet, 'Physical features'. These work sheets develop an important geographical understanding of ancient China. Identifying the different areas encourages students to consider the relationship between different locations and different lifestyles.

Students can read the Resource sheet, 'Growing food', and then use this information to complete the Activity sheet, 'Water: source of life'.

Extension ideas

- Students could develop their own simple map of their home or a made-up island using BOLTSS.
- Students could create a list of the ways they use water, including any machines that they use. They could then compare this information to the ways the ancient Chinese would have used water.
- Students could identify ways to save or reuse water today. Why is it important to save water?
- Students could research the monsoon season or flooding in the Yellow River to find out how this has affected people living in the area.
- Students could create a poster showing the features of either desert, tropical or mountainous regions.

Map skills

Being able to read and create maps are important skills when studying history. When creating your own maps, you need to make sure you include the following details: border, orientation, legend, title, scale and source. These details are also known as BOLTSS.

 **1** Use the words in the word bank to complete the labels beside the map.

Word bank

Border	Orientation	forests	map	east	symbols
Title	Scale	Source	know	top	

Ancient China ←



T_____ – Write a title explaining what the map shows. Be specific. This needs to appear at the t_____ of the map.

O_____ : This refers to the compass directions: north, e____, south and west. North always points to the top of the page. Sometimes this is shown with a small arrow.

Legend: This is a little box in the corner that explains any s_____ that you have used in your map to represent natural features such as f_____ or rivers or man-made features such as roads and cities.

B_____ : This means putting a fence or border around your m_____.

Source unknown

S_____ : Under the bottom left-hand corner of the map you write where you got your map from. If you don't k_____ the source, write 'source unknown'.

S_____ : The scale explains the distances on the map. It shows the distance that your map represents in real life.

Land and climate

China is the third largest country in the world. It is bordered by a sea on one side and a large mountain range on the other. These two features made it difficult for early Chinese people to travel and trade with the other important civilisations at the time, Rome and Greece. This meant that Chinese civilisation developed separately from other countries. The Chinese had to rely on themselves to create and make important objects because it was often too difficult to access ideas and inventions from other countries.

Deserts

In the north of China there is a large desert called the Gobi Desert. The Taklamakan Desert lies in the north-west of the country. The temperature in these deserts can range from 35 degrees Celsius to minus 35 degrees Celsius – from burning heat to freezing cold.

Mountains

The Himalayas are a large mountain range in the south-west of China. In the lower parts of the mountains, the weather is tropical, but the tops of the mountains have alpine or snowy weather.

Rainforests

The south-east of China is covered by tropical rainforest, bordered by the Pacific Ocean. The tropical areas often experience **monsoon** weather. A monsoon is a period of heavy rainfall that often leads to flooding.

Physical features

 **1** Using the Resource sheet, 'Land and climate' and an atlas, locate the following places on the map. Draw a symbol or use a colour to represent each feature.

- Gobi Desert
- Taklamakan Desert
- Himalayas
- Pacific Ocean
- Tropical rainforest region
- Huang Ho or Yellow River
- Chang Jiang or Yangtze River

Make sure you include BOLTSS on your map: Border, Orientation, Legend, Title, Scale, Source.

Hint: Legends can include colours, such as yellow to represent a desert, or symbols, such as a tree to represent a forest.



Growing food

Most civilisations began where people settled near water. Water is needed for so many things, such as drinking, cleaning and cooking. If a place has no easy access to water, people usually cannot live there.

The Yellow River (or Huang Ho) was one of the first places to be settled in China. It is named after the thick yellow earth surrounding it, called **loess**. When the Yellow River floods, the loess is washed over the land, where it helps crops to grow.



Although flooding is good for crops, it can damage buildings and people can drown. During the Shang Dynasty, the Chinese created **irrigation** channels to carry water to farms and stop the river flooding. There are only two main rivers in China (the Yellow River and the Yangtze), so man-made rivers called **canals** were also dug to **transport** water to other parts of the country. These canals became like highways for **trade**, enabling small boats to carry items from one place to another. They also meant people could catch fish to eat.

Access to water affects the type of food that can be grown in an area.

- In both northern and southern China people grew leeks, garlic, carrots, cabbage and fruit.
- In the south, because there was so much water, their main food was rice, which is grown in water-filled fields called paddies.
- People in the north had less access to water, so they grew barley and wheat, which they used to make noodles and bread.



Water: source of life

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Growing food', then answer the following questions.

1 Why do most civilisations begin near water? Give two reasons.

2 How did the Yellow River get its name?

3 What is the name of the other main river in China?

4 The Yellow River floods each year. Give two negative impacts of flooding.

5 Complete the following sentences:

Loess is _____. It is found _____.

Canals are _____.

The ancient Chinese used _____ to transport water to farms and help grow _____.

Water also helps us to grow food, which we need to live. The ancient Chinese ate different foods depending on where they lived and how much water was available. Our access to food today is very different. The ancient Chinese could only eat food grown near them, unless they were very rich. Nowadays we can go to a supermarket and buy food from all over the world.

6 What are some of the foods that the ancient Chinese ate?

7 What are some of the foods you eat now?

8 Why might the food you eat be different to what the ancient Chinese ate?

Objectives

- To develop an understanding of the hierarchy of social groups in ancient China
- To compare and contrast different social groups in ancient China
- To gain an understanding of some of the occupations at the time

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the location of ancient China and the period in which it existed.

Background

Honour was a very important aspect of ancient Chinese society. The social hierarchy was not based on the amount of money that people earned, as it is in some other societies, but on how groups were seen by others in their community.

The Chou/Zhou period featured a social system similar to the medieval feudal system, which comprised three tiers of people. The emperor was at the top, mandarins, warlords and landowners were in the middle and peasants were at the bottom. The groups were connected and relied on each other to survive. The emperor gave land and military protection to the mandarins, warlords and landowners, and expected military and government service in return. The mandarins, warlords and landowners defended the emperor and peasants, and got services from the peasants in return. The peasants were protected by the upper classes and provided services such as servants and food production in return. Every group had to give something in order to get something.

Starter activity

Encourage students to think about the way the animal kingdom is structured. Ask them which animals they would place on top and which would be put on the bottom. In small groups, using butcher's paper, have students try to organise the animal kingdom from highest to lowest. Ask students to share their ideas as a group, giving reasons for their decisions. Why did they place certain animals higher or lower? Is it to do with power or size or a food chain? Introduce the idea of ancient Chinese society and how it was ordered. Why were some groups at the top and why were some at the bottom?

Resource and Activity sheets

Introduce the Resource sheet, 'Social structure in ancient China', then have students answer the questions on the Activity sheet, 'Makers and sellers'. These work sheets introduce the hierarchy of ancient Chinese society. It may be helpful to discuss social hierarchies in general, and why they exist.

In the 'Farmers' Activity sheet, students fill in key words to complete a passage exploring the role of farmers and their place within society. The Activity sheet, 'Scholars and officials', looks at these two positions, and encourages students to relate the information to their own lives, suggesting equivalent roles in present-day society. The final Activity sheet, 'Emperors', presents a series of cloze activities outlining the life of an emperor. Some students may need to refer to a dictionary when completing this work sheet. Encourage students to see dictionaries as a useful source of information if words are unclear.

Extension ideas

- Students could compare one social group in ancient China with a modern social group, identifying similarities and differences.
- Have students create a glossary of any unfamiliar words, then use these to create sentences explaining the social structure in ancient China.
- Students could make their own diagram showing the hierarchy in ancient Chinese society. Encourage them to clearly represent the highest group and the lowest group using symbols such as a crown for the emperor.
- Students could research craftspeople in ancient China and make a list of the kind of objects that they made. The following website may be of assistance: http://www.ancientchina.co.uk/crafts/home_set.html

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Social structure in ancient China

People in ancient China were organised into different social groups. A person's position was usually based on their job. The highest-ranking member of the society was the emperor, because he was the most respected person. The lowest-ranking group were **merchants**. This was not because they were poor, but because their job was the least respected. In ancient China, **respect** and **honour** were very important. People who contributed the most to society were seen as the most honourable. This is why farmers, although they were quite poor, were still highly ranked in the social structure.

There were servants and slaves in ancient China, but they were seen as so low that they were not thought of as part of society. Some servants could gain power, however, if they worked for the emperor and became his advisors.



Makers and sellers

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Social structure in ancient China', then read the statements below and decide which group in society each man belongs to.

1



My name is Jizi.
I work hard every day to make beautiful clay figurines. Many rich people buy them from me. One day I hope to earn enough to employ some labourers to help me with my work. I sometimes wish that people respected me more. It is hard to make these figurines. Maybe if I earned enough to buy some land, people would treat me better.

The social group I belong to is _____.

2



My name is Tian.
I often buy clay figures from Jizi to sell when I travel along the Silk Road to distant countries. I make a lot of money from selling other people's items. People do not respect me because I do not make anything myself, but I feel that I should be respected for making so much money. I risk my life travelling to the barbarian countries! But instead I get taxed by my emperor, and he will not let me become a government official.

The social group I belong to is _____.

3 If you were the emperor of China, which social groups would you value. Why?

Farmers

 1 The information below is missing these three important words:

the	were	and
-----	------	-----

Fill in the blanks to make sense of the paragraphs.

Farmers _____ often among _____ poorest people in ancient China. They _____ respected for owning their own land, but they had to work hard to survive. They would weed _____ ground using hoes or metal tips attached to their fingers. _____ whole family had to help – even young children _____ elderly people. This meant that _____ family became very important in China.

There _____ three busiest times for _____ farmers _____: ploughing, sowing _____ harvesting.

- Ploughing was when they loosened _____ ground so that they could plant _____ seeds.
- Sowing was when they planted _____ seeds.
- Harvesting was when they collected _____ crops that they had grown. They would often plant more than one crop a year to make more money. This meant that they _____ often working all _____ time, on many different crops.

Farmers _____ busy even when they _____ not growing their crops. They had to look after _____ animals, repair tools _____ make cloth for their clothes. They would also fertilise _____ ground, to help _____ plants grow. They did this by putting ash, mud _____ manure on _____ fields.

Being a farmer was difficult because so many things could destroy your crops. Farmers always faced _____ possibility of floods, droughts, frost _____ bandits, who would steal their crops. When there _____ wars, peasant farmers would be called up to fight in _____ emperor's army. This meant that there _____ even less people to work on _____ farm, but they _____ still expected to produce _____ same amount of food.

Scholars and officials

-  1 Read the table below, then, working with a partner, answer the questions in your workbook.

Ancient China	Where I live
Scholars are people who are well known for their learning. They were respected because they knew many things. They could read and write – something not many people could do at that time. Many scholars wrote poetry and books.	Who is someone you respect for their learning? What is it about their learning that you respect?
In ancient China the government was ruled by the emperor, but it was run by government officials, who were scholars. The scholars would often count how many people there were in the country. This was called a census. It was done so the government knew how many people to tax.	Who is the leader of your country? Who helps them run the country?
Originally, government officials were chosen from rich families. This meant that poor people could not work in government. Eventually, the rules changed. Government officials were no longer chosen because they were rich. Instead, their selection was based on their exam scores. Some historians believe that this changed during the Han Dynasty, while others say it was Qin Shi Huang who made the change.	Do you think government officials today are more likely to be chosen because of their wealth or their exam scores?
Exams were very different back then. They were held annually at court by the 'Grand Historian'. Historians were highly respected in ancient China. Students had to be able to write 8000 Chinese characters. They also had to understand and explain traditional stories and poems. They used a bow and arrow to choose the question they wanted to answer. This showed that they had some military skills, as well as being intelligent.	How are exams today similar to those in ancient China? How are exams today different to those in ancient China?

Emperors

-  **1** Use the words in the word bank column to complete the paragraphs below.
You may want to use a dictionary to look up the meaning of some words.

Word bank	
heaven replaced kingdom rituals	In ancient China, emperors were believed to be 'sons of _____'. They were seen as half-god, half-man, chosen by the gods. Emperors had to perform important religious _____ to protect their _____. If disasters happened, the people took this as a sign that the gods had taken away the emperor's right to rule. This meant the emperor could be _____.
sacrificed sowed humans	The emperor had to identify the right times for the crops to be _____ and harvested. Sometimes he would sacrifice _____ because he thought it would protect his country. These people were usually _____ by being burnt alive or drowned.
Dowager regent current	Emperors were usually male. The position was traditionally passed down from the _____ emperor to his eldest son. If the son was too young to rule, his mother, the _____ Empress, became _____. This means she ruled until her son was old enough to rule himself. This gave some women a small amount of power.
eunuchs serve removed	In the palaces, the emperor was served by a group of people called _____. They were men whose genital organs had been _____. This was done to ensure that they could have no children or family, so they would only _____ the emperor.
concubines secondary principal legal	The emperor often had more than one wife. Some emperors had hundreds of wives, although there was usually a _____ wife, called the Empress. The emperor also often had _____, who were like _____, or lesser, wives with no _____ power. The women were often searched by eunuchs when they came to visit the emperor in case they were carrying weapons to kill him.

Objectives

- To learn about the treatment of women in ancient China
- To explore the life of a famous woman who lived in ancient China
- To compare and contrast the lives of women in the past to now
- To understand the strong importance of the family as a unit in China

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the location of ancient China and the period in which it existed.

Background

The lives of women in ancient China were often very restricted. Society had many expectations of what they could and couldn't do. Most women, as the newest and lowest member of their husband's family, had no power. Sometimes, though, if a woman lived long enough, she was able to gain some power over her daughter-in-law, if she had one, or as the eldest member of the family. In families, the eldest member was well respected, and was usually considered to be the 'head of the family', even if she was a woman. Even the emperor had to listen to the wishes of his older female relatives.

Starter activity

Ask students to create a mind map showing what they believe women's lives would have been like in ancient China. Have them share their findings with the class.

Resource and Activity sheets

'Women's lives' is a Resource sheet intended to clarify the general position of women in ancient China. This is supported by the Activity sheet, 'Now and then', in which students match up definitions and answer some true/false questions before comparing the treatment of women in ancient China to the present day. If you require further information about Confucius, who is mentioned briefly in this section, please refer to Unit 8.

The Activity sheet, 'Girls' lives', presents information about the treatment of girls in ancient China. When reading through this work sheet, encourage students to compare this to their own lives.

The 'Ban Zhao' Activity sheet may be best done as a class task. Students need to use important historiographical skills to analyse different interpretations.

In the Activity sheet, 'Marriage and divorce', students use synonyms to complete a cloze activity describing marriage and divorce in ancient China.

Extension ideas

- Students could research the lives of women in ancient Greece and Rome. Compare these to the lives of women in ancient China.
- Each student could write a diary entry explaining how they think foot binding would feel, remembering that the toes get broken and pushed underneath.
- Have each student write a short letter to a woman who they find inspirational. This could be a relative, a friend or someone famous.
- In pairs, students could list the positives and negatives of being a female in ancient China.

Women's lives

In ancient China, men were usually the head of the family. They made all the decisions and worked to support the rest of the family. A man could even legally kill his children, if he wanted to.

The birth of a female child was usually a disappointment. Her parents would often worry about how expensive her future wedding would be. Women could bring dishonour to their family by not behaving appropriately – people would believe that her parents had not taught her how a woman should behave.

As they grew up, girls and women were often seen as only temporary members of their family. This is because when girls got married, they usually left their family to live with their husband's family. The husband's mother would then treat the new bride like a servant.

Many people, including scholars such as Confucius, believed that the home was the proper place for women. Women had to:

- keep away from guests
- spin silk or hemp into cloth
- sew
- weave
- cook
- care for the children
- be respectful
- yield to others' wishes.



Women in ancient China were seen as **inferior** to men.

Some women were able to get jobs outside the house. They were usually from a scholar's family and had some education. Some women worked as scholars themselves, and even wrote books, like Ban Zhao. Others became female physicians. This was allowed in order to protect the feelings of female patients, as male physicians were not permitted to touch or talk directly to women. Women could not become teachers or politicians, as they were not allowed to speak freely around men. This made it impossible for women to gain any real power.

Now and then

Read the Resource sheet, 'Women's lives'.

 **1** Draw a line to match each word to its definition.

- | | |
|------------------------|--|
| a physician | making cloth by linking the threads together |
| b inferior | a doctor |
| c weaving | your husband's mother |
| d mother-in-law | giving in to something |
| e yielding | a lesser thing |

2 Decide whether each of the following statements is true or false.

- | | |
|---|-------|
| a Women in ancient China were seen as inferior to men. | _____ |
| b No women were allowed to work outside the home. | _____ |
| c Confucius was a woman who wrote a book. | _____ |
| d A father could kill his children if he wanted to. | _____ |

3 Compare the descriptions of women's life in ancient China with how women are seen and live in Australia today.

Ancient China	Modern Australia
Women were seen as:	Women are seen as:
Women could do:	Women can do:
Women could not:	Women cannot:

Girls' lives



Rewrite the scrambled words to complete the passage.

My name is Lihua. I am **(net)** _____ years old and live in the Sui **(aytsnyD)** _____ in China (615 CE). My father is a famous **(clrasho)** _____ and he has taught me some **(sretchacar)** _____ so that I can write a little. I do not know many other girls who can write – not even my **(hermto)** _____ can.

Only boys get to go to **(lhcoso)** _____. My brother Ao will go to school next year when he is ten. I haven't seen him much since he was **(venes)** _____ years old. Boys live

separately from their **(rsetiss)** _____ at that age. If he is smart and works hard he will **(embceo)** _____ a scholar too.

My mother has **(auhtgt)** _____ me to embroider, sew and make **(heoss)** _____. These are important **(klisls)** _____ that I will need when I get **(deirram)** _____. It is very important that my behaviour in my husband's **(usohe)** _____ does not bring disgrace to my **(lyifma)** _____. My mother-in-law would say that my **(rnsteap)** _____ did not teach me how to be a good **(fwie)** _____.

In order to make me more beautiful so I will find a **(bndashu)** _____, my mother has started binding my **(efet)** _____ to make them smaller. It hurts a lot. My **(esot)** _____ get pressed down underneath my feet until the **(nsebo)** _____ break. Then my feet are bound up to make them **(lsmla)** _____ and delicate. It is difficult to **(kwla)** _____ – my feet feel like they are on fire. Mother says it stops hurting after a couple of **(raesy)** _____, but I will have to keep **(gdinbni)** _____ them for the rest of my **(feli)** _____.

Interesting facts

Historians do not know exactly when foot binding started. Some believe that it started during the Tang Dynasty (618–907 CE), but others have suggested the Sui, Han or Qin dynasties. The aim of foot binding was to make the feet less than seven centimetres long. Foot binding was usually done by mothers or aunts, who felt that they were giving their daughters or nieces a better life. This practice was usually done to girls in wealthier families, whose parents and future husbands could afford to look after a woman who could barely walk. Some peasant girls also had their feet bound, in the hope they would get a richer husband.

Ban Zhao

Ban Zhao (approximately 45 CE–116 CE) was the most famous female historian in ancient China. She lived during the Han Dynasty. Her father, Ban Biao, was a scholar and her mother could also read and write. Ban Zhao was taught to do the same. She also had twin brothers; one became a scholar and the other became a general.

At the age of fourteen she was married to a local boy, Cao Shishu. In her husband’s house she was treated like a servant. Her life became even harder when her husband died young, leaving her alone with her children.

When her brother Ban Gu, the scholar, was executed, Ban Zhao returned home to finish the history book he had been writing. She finished writing *The Book of Han*, taught females in the royal family, became a librarian at court and wrote several books. While at court she also became a close advisor and lady-in-waiting to the Dowager Empress Deng, who was the regent for her infant son, the emperor.

Ban Zhao is best known for her book *Lessons for Women*. It is believed that this was written to instruct her daughters on how to behave in their husband’s house. Some historians see this book as telling women to follow men, while others believe that it is helping women.

-  1 Read the following extracts from *Lessons for Women* and suggest reasons why historians might have such different opinions.

‘[S]he is lowly and weak, and should ... humble herself before others.’

‘Yet only to teach men and not to teach women ... [W]hy should it not be ... girls’ education as well as boys’...?’

Reasons why historians might believe Ban Zhao was telling women to follow men	Reasons why historians might believe Ban Zhao was helping women

Marriage and divorce

-  1 Match the synonyms in the word bank to the words in brackets and complete the information below. (A synonym is a word that has the same meaning as another word. For example, 'small' is a synonym of 'tiny'.)

Marriages were normally (arranged) _____ by parents. Girls had no say in who they married. Often the first time they met their husband was on their wedding day. Marriages were sometimes arranged with the help of a matchmaker, who helped pick the right (partner) _____.

A wedding in ancient China was different to the marriage ceremonies we have now. The bride gave (slippers) _____ to her husband and did a dance, while her husband would bring a wild goose to (symbolise) _____ true love. Then the marriage was finalised with a (feast) _____. The next morning the new bride would bow and offer tea to her husband's parents to show that she belonged to them. If her (betrothed) _____ died before they were married, the girl was married to his (memorial tablet) _____.

The bride was considered to be her mother-in-law's (slave) _____. She would only gain (respect) _____ once she had given birth to a son. If she was unable to produce a son, her husband might marry a new wife. Men could marry several wives, and also have (courtesans) _____, although only rich men could afford to do this. The marriage to the first wife, who was usually the principal wife, was seen to be more official than the man's other marriages.

Divorces were very easy to get. A man could get a divorce if his wife fought with his parents, if she couldn't have children, if she committed adultery, showed (jealousy) _____, had an incurable disease, talked too much or (committed theft) _____. They did not need to go to court to get a divorce, they could just separate, or he could (expel) _____ her from the home.

Word bank

organised
shoes
concubines
envy
spouse
eject
honour
fiancé
gravestone
servant
banquet
stole
represent

Objectives

- To develop an understanding of everyday life in ancient China
- To understand how writing has developed over time
- To develop an understanding of the similarities and differences between ancient and modern life

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the social structure of ancient China.

Background

Everyday life for the ancient Chinese was very different to life in Australia today. Although we still write, play sports, wear clothes and take medicine, in the past these things were done in different ways. When playing sports in the past, the focus was not on competition but rather on showing your good character. It was more important to be a 'good sport' and behave properly, even when losing, than it was to be a physically strong.

Starter activity

Ask students to draw a picture of the kinds of clothes they usually wear. Compare outfits as a class, then encourage students to discuss the reasons for their chosen outfits. Talk about colours and fashions for boys and girls. Are there any differences? Would rich and poor people wear different clothes? How might they differ? Expand the discussion to consider the clothes worn in ancient China and the reasons for these.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet 'Clothing' gives students an understanding of the clothes worn in ancient China. Students draw appropriate clothing onto two illustrations to demonstrate their understanding. It might be helpful to bring in some pictures of ancient Chinese dress for students to refer to.

The Activity sheet, 'Medicine', explores the differences between medicine in the past and today. The Resource sheet, 'Writing', introduces students to Chinese writing, and presents a table of pictograms that can be used when completing the Activity sheet, 'Strange characters'. The Activity sheet, 'Sport and recreation', allows students to compare their own experiences of sport and recreation to those enjoyed in ancient China.

Extension ideas

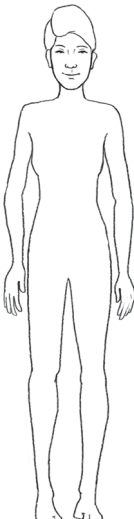
- Students could draw clothing for all the different social groups in ancient China. Encourage them to conduct research to ensure that their chosen outfits are accurate.
- Have students write a poem or short story about living in ancient China.
- Students could design new clothes for the Emperor (encourage them to think about what an emperor would wear and why).

Clothing

People in ancient China wore similar styles of clothing, but there were some differences.

	Emperor and Imperial family	Nobility	Merchants/traders	Peasants/poor people
Colours	only the emperor and his relatives could wear the colour yellow	various colours, including purple, scarlet, green and blue	often wore black	often wore natural-coloured clothing (brown and dirty white)
Materials	• silk • fox and squirrel furs	• silk • fox and squirrel furs	• forbidden to wear silk	• material made from hemp or nettles • sheep skins in winter
Shoes	silk and fine leather	silk and fine leather	leather	barefoot or straw sandals
Styles	• long tunics like dressing gowns that reached the ground, with large sleeves • trousers underneath	• long tunics like dressing gowns that reached the ground, with large sleeves • trousers underneath	• long tunics that reached their thighs • loose trousers and shorter jackets, like those the peasants wore, but made of better material	• loose trousers and short jackets

 **1** Draw clothes onto each of the following illustrations and label them.

A woman from the Imperial family 	A peasant man 
---	--

Medicine

Ancient Chinese medicine was very different to today’s Western medicine. The ancient Chinese believed that the body was **sacred** and should not be damaged. This made it hard for them to learn about how the human body worked. Today, doctors conduct **autopsies** to examine the human body and learn more about it.

The Chinese mostly used herbs to fix health problems. They also used **acupuncture**, which involves putting lots of thin needles into pressure points in the body to help treat illnesses. People still use alternative forms of healing such as these. Sometimes sick people will use both Chinese and Western medicine.

Chinese doctors became very good at **diagnosing** illnesses. They could sometimes work out what was wrong with someone by touching them and checking their pulse. Nowadays we use blood tests to find the problem.

-  1 Working with a partner, compare three similarities or differences between medicine in ancient China and today’s Western medicine.

Ancient China	Today
Example: The ancient Chinese did not know much about how the human body worked because they believed that the body was sacred and shouldn’t be damaged.	Example: Now doctors will often do autopsies (examining dead bodies) to study the human body.

Writing

Ancient Chinese language was first written over 3500 years ago. It is very different to modern Chinese. Chinese writing doesn't use an alphabet like English does. We use the 26 letters in our alphabet to make thousands of words. The Chinese use pictograms, or 'characters', instead of letters. A pictogram is a picture used to represent a word. In English, 'China' is written using five letters, but in Chinese it is shown with just one character.

When the Chinese first developed their written language there were about 3000 characters. Each character looked like the thing it represented. Over time, the shapes slowly changed so they were quicker to write. They ended up looking very different.

The following table shows how some Chinese characters have changed over time.

	Early Chinese (around 2205–1027 BCE)	Around Han Dynasty (around 206 BCE–220 CE)	Modern Chinese (around 2000 CE)
human			
fish			
mountain			
rain			
moon			
sun			
ear			

By the Han Dynasty scholars were expected to learn about 8000 characters. Scholars and the wealthy were the only people in ancient China who were able to read and write. They were mostly men, although some wealthy girls or daughters of scholars were also taught to read and write.

Strange characters

Read the Resource sheet, 'Writing', then complete the following activities.

 **1** Draw the following symbols.

	Early Chinese	Around Han Dynasty	Modern Chinese
human			
sun			

2 Why do you think the early Chinese characters for 'sun' and 'human' look like they do?

3 Why did the characters change over time?

4 Imagine that you live in ancient China and need to write a letter. Create pictures to represent each of the words in your letter.

Dear	Mum	I	need	two
ox	for	my	field.	Can
you	give	me	some	money
to	buy	some?	Love	_____ (your name)

5 Which words were easy to create pictures for? Which were hard?

Sport and recreation

The Chinese played many different sports, although the poorer people didn't get much time to play because they were so busy working or farming. The Chinese enjoyed playing sports such as boxing, wrestling, polo, archery and shuttlecock. They also played a game called **Touhu** where they tried to throw arrows into a container. Sports were mostly played by men, although some women also took part.

-  **1** Which sports are popular today? Which ones are your favourites?

Martial arts first began in China. This sport involves learning how to defend yourself without weapons. Many of the actions look like the movements of animals, which is not surprising, given the importance of farming in China.

- 2** Why might people in ancient China need to defend themselves without weapons? Who would have used these skills?

The ancient Chinese were very fond of music and created many musical instruments. They had one called a **qin**, which looked like a box with seven strings on it. They also played bamboo flutes and drums. Some people believe that the practice of foot binding began when dancers bound their feet to make their movements look light and graceful.

- 3** List two similarities and two differences between modern music you listen to and the music that the ancient Chinese listened to.

Objectives

- To identify crimes in ancient China and the punishments for breaking the law
- To recognise the importance of honour in ancient Chinese culture
- To compare and contrast the treatment of criminals in modern and ancient societies
- To explore the role of the family in the development of laws

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the social structure of ancient China.

Background

In ancient China it was rare for people to be imprisoned for many years, as criminals are today. This was because the cost of feeding the criminals was so high. However, some people were sentenced to do hard labour, as a kind of slavery, on the royal barges, in the army or in the mines. Most punishments in ancient China tended to involve some kind of physical punishment, as a reminder of what would happen to people who broke the law. This might mean being mutilated, branded or even killed.

Starter activity

Ask the class to come up with 5–10 modern laws. Discuss the aim of each law. Is it to punish people? To protect the community? Ask the students to rank the laws in order of their importance.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students should read the first Resource sheet, 'Honour and crimes', before completing the Activity sheet, 'Honour and dishonour'. These work sheets identify the importance of honour and family to the creation of laws. Discuss as a class why honour and family were so important in ancient China.

The Resource sheet, 'Punishments', introduces the forms of punishment commonly used in ancient China. The Activity sheet, 'How were they punished?', presents different types of crimes and asks students to determine appropriate punishments, according to ancient Chinese law. Discuss how fair or unfair these punishments were, particularly where the crimes seemed particularly minor. Some of the punishments were deliberately harsh in order to keep people from reoffending. This may be an uncomfortable topic for some students, and some terms may need to be explained in class.

The final Activity sheet, 'Modern law and order', invites students to compare and contrast the laws that we have today with those used in ancient China.

Extension ideas

- Encourage students to imagine that they are stuck on a desert island with only the people from their class. What laws would they make, and how would they punish people who broke those laws?
- Students could write a diary entry account of a witness who saw someone being punished. The diary entry should explain how this made the person feel.
- Students could list punishments used in ancient China and suggest explanations for why each was used.

Honour and crimes

Honour was very important in ancient China. To have honour, the ancient Chinese had to earn the **respect** of the community and behave well as a member of their family. Families were the centre of ancient Chinese society. It was only by working together and following the head of the family that people were able to get things done. It was important to follow the laws in order to earn respect and have honour. People wanted to avoid breaking laws, which would bring **shame** to their family.

Many ancient Chinese laws were about respecting the family ancestors and their burial grounds. There were rules about respecting parents and doing everything they asked. The people also had to protect their emperor. If the emperor was injured or killed, the whole country would be dishonoured. People who disobeyed the emperor were punished harshly.



Many ancient Chinese could not read. This made it difficult for them to know the law. Local officials and wealthy landowners in an area were supposed to tell their people about the laws and punishments. It was felt that if people knew the shame and loss of honour that would come from breaking a law, then they would obey.

Many ancient Chinese laws were designed to protect the emperor.

Honour and dishonour

Read the Resource sheet, 'Honour and crimes', then answer the following questions.

 **1** What were the two most important things in ancient Chinese society?

2 How did people find out about laws and punishments?

3 List two people/groups that the ancient Chinese had to respect.

4 What does honour mean to you?

5 Suggest four laws that you think the ancient Chinese needed to obey in order to protect their families. Explain why these laws would have been important. An example has been provided.

Laws	Explanations
Honour your mother and father.	If people do not obey their parents they may hurt themselves or their family.

Punishments

The punishments for breaking laws in ancient China were very harsh. They were designed to make sure that people would obey the laws. Some crimes that we consider to be very minor were punished quite harshly. Fathers were even allowed to kill their own children if they misbehaved.

These punishments may seem extreme, but families were essential to survival in ancient China. If one person on a farm failed to do their work, the whole family could starve. Obedience to family was highly important in ancient Chinese society.

It was even a crime to tell officials that a family member had broken the law. Anyone who did this could be beaten 100 times. And if the information they gave was not true, the **informant** could be strangled.

Punishments in ancient China

- Beating with a bamboo stick was seen as a minor punishment.
- Students were beaten for misbehaving and to improve their learning.
- Pickpockets might be **branded** with red-hot metal on their arms.
- Other criminals could have their faces branded, be given into slavery or even be killed.
- A girl who insulted her parents might be strangled.
- One person who disagreed with the emperor was given two options: he could either commit suicide or become an eunuch.
- If someone committed a crime against the emperor they would be tortured and beheaded. A beheading was considered to be the most shameful punishment, because it meant that the **noblest** part of your body was removed.

How were they punished?

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Punishments', then read the following accounts and decide what punishment each person would have been given.



My parents wanted me to marry a man who was much older than me. I argued with them and called my father a horrible name.

Her punishment is _____.

I whispered to the boy next to me in class because I needed to borrow some ink.



His punishment is _____.



I did not like the emperor so I tried to poison him so that his son would gain power.

His punishment is _____.

My father was going to try to poison the emperor, so I told the officials what I knew.



His punishment is _____.

Modern law and order

Laws are made to control society and make sure that everyone behaves in a way that is considered acceptable.

 **1** Who makes laws today?

2 Who would have made the laws in ancient China? (Hint: Who was the highest-ranking person in ancient Chinese society?)

3 There are many laws in our modern society. Which laws do you think are the most important? List at least three.

The family was considered to be the most important part of ancient Chinese society, so most laws were made to protect the family.

4 Who do you think is the most important group in your society? How do the laws we have show this?

There are a number of groups who make sure that people who break the laws are caught and punished. These include police, lawyers, judges and prison wardens.

5 What kinds of punishments are used today?

6 How are these different to the punishments used in ancient China?

Objectives

- To learn about the gear and transport used by armies in ancient China
- To develop an understanding of the planning involved in preparing for battles
- To identify the importance of the army and military skills to ancient Chinese life

Prior knowledge

Students should have a basic understanding of the different dynasties that ruled throughout Chinese history.

Background

Military skills were very important in ancient China. Even scholars, who never usually fought, were expected to have these skills. Given the amount of civil fighting within China, these skills were often used. The armies were made up of peasants who were conscripted to fight for several years before they could return home. Some soldiers stayed in the army as regular soldiers after they had completed their conscripted time. Some found it exciting, while others enjoyed the money or the change in lifestyle.

Starter activity

In small groups, have students brainstorm around the topic of military forces. Why is it important to have an army? What skills should a good leader have? Discuss their answers as a class.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students should read the Resource sheet, 'Conflicts', before completing the Activity sheet, 'Fighting fit'. These work sheets provide some background on the conflicts that occurred in ancient China.

The Activity sheet, 'Weapons and gear', provides students with a visual understanding of some of the weapons that were used in those times. Students identify weapons by matching illustrations with their descriptions. The Activity sheet, 'Chariots', presents a cloze activity introducing chariots and their role in warfare.

The last Activity sheet, 'The art of war', looks at Sun Tzu's ideas about war. This activity is intended to be done in pairs. Emphasise that there are no right or wrong answers, as different people will see different situations as ideal. This last activity is a great task to extend into a group discussion where students share their answers and the explanations for their decisions.

Extension ideas

- Have students research weapons that are used today. Students could create a poster comparing these modern weapons to ancient weapons.
- Students could research a famous warrior from ancient China, such as Sun Tzu. The following website may be of assistance: <http://scienceofstrategy.org/main/content/sun-tzus-life>
- Show students the story of Hua Mulan – a fictional story about a woman who dressed as a man so she could fight in place of her father. Students could then write their own version. See <http://www.yellowbridge.com/onlinelit/mulan.php>
- Students could research other ancient Chinese weapons, then draw one and label it. See <http://history.cultural-china.com/en/182History5440.html>

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Conflicts

China was involved in many early **conflicts**. Sometimes Chinese armies fought against the **nomadic** people of the deserts, the Xiongu. Because they were always moving from place to place, the nomads had excellent horse skills, which made them a feared enemy of the Chinese. The Chinese army also fought against bandits and robbers who tried to control wealthy areas, like trade routes. The Chinese believed that people who lived outside of China were barbarians, and they fought hard to prove that the Chinese were **dominant**.

Much of the time, however, the Chinese armies fought each other. In the early years of China, at the end of the Chou/Zhou period (1027–221 BCE), when the country was divided into many small kingdoms, the kings fought each other to take control of other kingdoms and make themselves more powerful. Whole cities were destroyed in these violent battles. Sometimes the leader of the losing side was killed as a human sacrifice. Troops who surrendered were often killed. Sometimes the fighting was so bad that the troops wore their armour day and night, until their bodies crawled with lice.

One of the most powerful kings was Qin Shi Huang. Once he defeated all the other kings he became known as the 'First Emperor'. From then on, the Chinese army worked to protect the emperor. This only became a problem when several different people claimed the throne. This happened often during the Three Kingdoms period (220–260 CE), as well as during the Dynasties of the North and South (317–589 CE).

Fighting fit

Read the Resource sheet 'Conflicts', then answer the following questions.

-  **1** Name three groups that the ancient Chinese armies fought against.

- 2** Why did the ancient Chinese armies fight against other Chinese armies?

- 3** Why were armies so important to the emperor?

- 4** Write down two reasons why battles were so bad for the soldiers.

- 5** During which time periods was there the most fighting? Why?

- 6** Write down two facts about conflict in ancient China that you find interesting. Explain what you find interesting about these things.

Weapons and gear

In ancient China, the most respected weapon was the bow and arrow. **Archery** was used in the armies, but it was also used in other ways. Scholars shot arrows into targets to pick the questions they would answer in their exams. In some court cases, archery was used to help work out whether people were telling the truth. If they were able to hit the target, it was believed that a god was on their side and had judged that they were telling the truth.

Soldiers used many weapons to protect themselves, such as spears for long-range fighting. Swords and sabres were also used, but because they were shorter, they were seen as more dangerous, because you had to stand closer to the enemy to fight.

 **1** Draw a line linking each weapon description with the correct picture.

Chinese halberd

A short sword that was straight-edged.



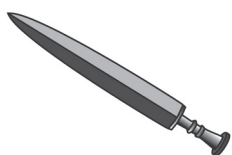
Chinese dagger-axe

A spear that has sharp points on the end and on the side.



short sword

A sword with a curved blade.



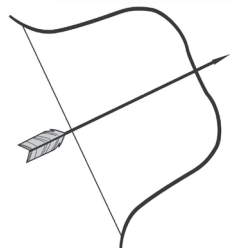
sabre

A weapon used to shoot small arrows from a distance.



bow

A short knife that is thrown from a distance.



throwing dagger

A spear that has both a dagger and an axe on the end.



Chariots

 1 Use the words in the word bank to complete the following paragraphs.

Chariots were two-wheeled wooden _____ that were pulled by horses. They were used by ancient Chinese armies to **intimidate** their _____. Most of the armies in ancient China were made up of **infantry**, which means _____ who are on _____. People driving _____ in chariots pulled by horses would have seemed very _____.

Chariots were mainly used by the _____ warriors, because they were the only people who could afford to pay for the _____. Most chariots held three people. There was a driver, who directed the horses, and a rich or noble warrior, who would usually fire _____. The third person was usually the warrior’s _____, who would help by handing over arrows and protecting their master.

Sometimes chariots were used by the _____, so they could watch the battle and make plans. Some _____ had crow’s-nest chariots. These had a small _____ on top so that generals could watch the battle and signal _____ to their troops. It was easier to watch the battle from high up, but it could also be more _____.

2 The generals used chariots because _____

3 Most people in the army did not use chariots because _____

4 Explain the advantages and disadvantages of using a crow’s-nest chariot.

Word bank

soldiers

scary

servant

movements

richest

carts

tower

generals

foot

fast

dangerous

arrows

armies

horses

enemies

Advantages	Disadvantages

The art of war

War was so important to the ancient Chinese that they wrote books about how to fight. The most famous of these is *The Art of War*, written by Sun Tzu, who was a general in the Chinese army. Sun Tzu said there were five factors that needed to be considered when making decisions in war. These were moral law, heaven, earth, commander and method/discipline.

-  **1** Imagine that you and a partner are generals in ancient China. Describe your ideal conditions for war. Remember: There are no right or wrong answers – everyone has their own preferences.

Five factors	What they mean	Describe your ideal conditions by answering the questions
The moral law	- How do we get the soldiers to believe in their commander? - How do we get the soldiers to follow orders?	
Heaven	- Is it night or day? - What season is it? - What time is it? - Is it hot or cold?	
Earth	- How far away is the enemy? - How are we keeping ourselves safe? - Where is the danger?	
Commander	- What values does the commander have? - How is the commander seen by the army?	
Method/discipline	- How is the army organised? - How are we getting supplies? - How is the money being spent?	

Objectives

- To develop an understanding of the different religious beliefs present in ancient China
- To identify important practices in preparing for the afterlife and ancestor worship
- To compare and contrast burial practices of poor and rich people
- To explore methods of telling the future

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge is required for this unit.

Background

Religion was very important in ancient China, but many people did not consider themselves followers of one particular religion. Many Chinese followed Confucian ideas as well as Buddhism or Taoism. For many Chinese, the most important aspect of religion was the ancestor worship which, given the importance of family in ancient China, is not surprising. This ancestor worship may also be linked to the lowly status of women in ancient China. As a woman joined her husband's family she left the worship of her ancestors to her father and brothers and was instead expected to support and protect her husband's family and ancestors. This meant she was seen as less connected to her own ancestors, but not quite connected to her husband's.

Starter activity

As a class, make a graph of students' religions. This could include information such as religion, place of worship, frequency of attendance and importance of religion to their life. Hold a discussion about the similarities and differences in students' religious beliefs and practices.

Resource and Activity sheets

Have students read the Resource sheet, 'The four religions of China', before they complete the Activity sheet, 'Comparison of religions.' Go through the results as a class. Students then work with a partner to create a rule that would be appropriate for each religion.

The Resource sheet, 'Death and ancestor worship', explores funeral customs and the practice of ancestor worship. In the Activity sheet, 'Death', students complete sentences and reorder sentences to consolidate their learning.

The final Activity sheet, 'Telling the future', examines some of the methods astrologers and sages used to tell the future. Ensure that students understand the words in the word bank before starting this activity, although they should still be able to place them by context.

Extension ideas

- Students could research religion in modern China. What do most Chinese believe now?
- Each student could pick one of the religious leaders and research their life. There is plenty of information about Confucius and Buddha available, but very little is known about Lao Tzu.
- Students could write a short paragraph about the religion they follow, stating who the leader is, when the religion was started, beliefs, gods, who follows the religion and why.

The four religions of China

Folk religion

Folk religion is the oldest religion in China. It is so old that there is no identified founder of the religion. Its followers worshipped a number of different gods or spirits, including gods of nature, dragons and ancestors. They believed that if they prayed to the gods, they would be protected from misfortune. They also performed rituals to keep the gods happy.

Confucianism

Confucianism was started in China by a famous philosopher named Master Kong, whose name was later written as Confucius. He taught people about the importance of ancestor worship, tradition and family. One of his most important laws stated that people should be good to each other. Many followers were scholars, as Confucianism valued education. Although many Confucians believed that Heaven was their supreme being, they cared more about behaving the right way than about gods.

Buddhism

Buddhism was started in India in the 500s BCE by Prince Gautama, who later became known as Buddha, the enlightened one. Followers of Buddhism believe that following the middle path is the most important thing. This means not having too much or too little, as either would make you unhappy. The Chinese worshipped Buddha and Guanyin, the goddess of mercy. Buddhism appealed to many poor or mistreated Chinese, who felt that their lives were difficult.

Daoist/Taoist

The Daoist or Taoist religion was about freedom from rules. This religion was created in China around the 300s BCE, possibly by a man named Lao Tzu. Instead of good or bad, Daoists believed in the balance of yin and yang, or light and dark. They believed that each person had 36 000 deities, or god-like figures, inside them.

Comparison of religions

-  1 Read the Resource sheet, 'The four religions of China', and complete the following table.

	Folk religion	Confucianism	Buddhism	Taoism
Who was the founder or leader of the religion?				
Where was the religion started?				
Main beliefs				
God/s worshipped				

- 2 Working with a partner, create a law that you think might have been used in the religions below. Explain why your law would fit that religion. An example has been provided.

Law for Confucianism

Law: Everyone must study at school until they are at least fifteen.

Explanation: This law would fit because Confucianism values scholars and studying.

Law for Buddhism

Law for Taoism

Death and ancestor worship

Ancestor worship

Many of the people in ancient China practised ancestor worship. They believed that their **deceased** ancestors, such as grandparents and great-grandparents, were looking after them. In return for this protection, the living family members had to practise special rituals to protect and worship their ancestors.

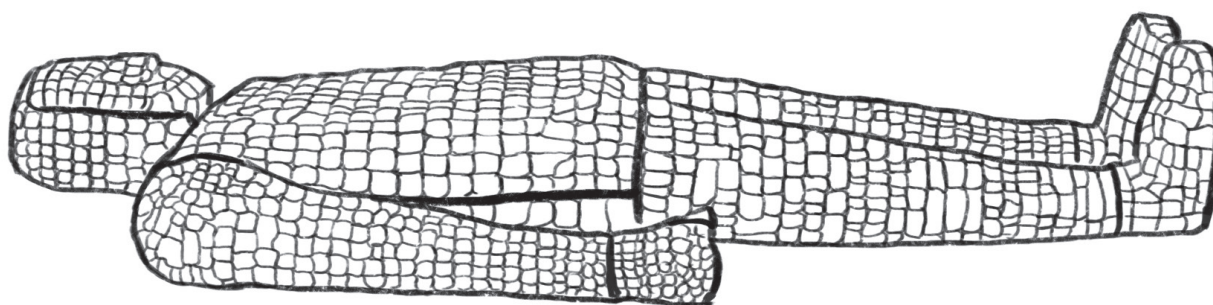
Death

The Chinese would bury their loved ones with items that they had needed in life. If they were rich this might include clothes, food, jewels and even animals. An extremely rich person might even get a **jade** suit made for their funeral. If the person was poor, though, they would be buried with clothes and food that were made out of paper. Some rich people were buried with animals and slaves to serve them in their next life. Sometimes the slaves and animals were killed and buried. Other times, however, they were buried alive.

Funerals

Family and friends would dress in white and gather at a funeral to grieve together. Rich people would pay for enormous tombs in mountainsides and hire musicians to entertain. The poor could only make little straw huts to show their respect for their relatives.

Children were expected to mourn their parents for three years. During that time they would wear only white, and would also complete special rituals for their parents.



Emperors and extremely wealthy people would sometimes be buried in a jade suit.

Death

Read the Resource sheet, 'Death and ancestor worship', then answer the following questions.

 **1** Circle the correct ending to go with each sentence starter.

- | | |
|---|--|
| a Ancient Chinese practised | ancestor worship.
making straw huts. |
| b Children were expected to | mourn their parents for two years.
mourn their parents for three years. |
| c Poor people were usually buried with | slaves and the possessions they owned.
paper copies of their possessions. |

2 Rearrange these fragments to form correct sentences, then write each full sentence in the space provided.

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------|
| a The ancient Chinese | white at funerals. | often wore |
| <hr/> | | |
| b buried alive or | Slaves could be | killed before they were buried. |
| <hr/> | | |
| c where people were buried. | to cut down trees | It was a crime |
| <hr/> | | |
| d A very rich person | in a jade suit. | might be buried |
| <hr/> | | |

3 Were there any similarities between funerals for the rich and the poor? What does this tell you about their beliefs regarding the afterlife?

Telling the future

-  1 Use the words in the word bank to complete these paragraphs. Use a dictionary to help you.

	Word bank
In ancient China there were wise men called _____ who watched over the stars and planets. They used what they saw to make _____ about the future. In the 300s BCE scholars made a book called <i>The Book of Silk</i>, which listed 29 different forms of comets and explained the different futures that these _____.	sages foretold predictions
Sages also believed in the power of four celestial animals, which they believed were connected to the _____ and to God. The _____ of these animals was the dragon, who took the emperors to heaven when they died. The phoenix was the second-highest animal. It was used as a _____ by the emperor. The third-highest animal was the tortoise, which was believed to be the animal that began the universe. Lastly, the unicorn was thought to be able to tell the difference between the _____ and the guilty.	innocent heavens highest symbol
Another important tool used to tell the future was _____ bones, such as the shoulder bones of an ox or the shell of a tortoise. The person wanting to know the future would write a _____ on the bone. The bones would then be heated and the _____ that appeared would be interpreted by the sage.	question oracle cracks
The Chinese also sometimes used the <i>I Ching</i>, or <i>Book of</i> _____, to tell their future. A set of _____ with marks were put in a container, which was shaken until a stick fell out. The marks on the stick would tell the person's _____.	future changes sticks

Objectives

- To develop an understanding of the importance of silk in ancient China
- To recognise the difficulties the Chinese faced in trading to other countries
- To identify the impacts of trading on ancient China

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of scale and distance in atlases and maps. They should also be familiar with the location of ancient China.

Background

Trade is always important in a developing civilisation. It exposes the people to different religions, views of the world and cultural experiences. In ancient China, trade was driven by one main product: silk. For a long time, nobody else was able to make silk. This gave the Chinese a monopoly on the product, making it both highly desirable and a symbol of wealth.

Starter activity

Ask the students to look at some objects that they have with them in the classroom, such as their clothing, stationery, books, etc. In groups, have them find out where the items were made (look at their labels) and then, using an atlas or computer, map the distance the objects had to travel.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Silk', introduces the development and importance of silk. The Resource sheet, 'The Silk Road', further explains the connection of silk to trade and why it was so important to the Chinese.

The Activity sheet, 'Maps and trading', illustrates physical realities of trade, including the distances covered and the climates experienced. Check that students are comfortable interpreting scales in order to ensure that they understand the distances. It may also be helpful to use string to help the students measure, as the Silk Road was not straight and would be difficult to accurately measure using only a ruler.

The Resource sheet, 'Contacts and conflicts', outlines China's interactions with other countries. Students then complete the map on the Activity sheet, 'Trading with other countries'. They may need to refer back to the first Resource sheet, 'The Silk Road', as well as an atlas, when completing this activity. The answers to the final two questions on this sheet are likely to be: by sea – India, Japan and Korea. By road – Macedonia and Persia/Iran. Rome would probably have been a combination of the two. Looking at an atlas and the Silk Road map should make this fairly clear.

Extension ideas

- Have students imagine what life would be like if there was no trade, and they only had access to local products, then encourage them to write a diary entry depicting life under these conditions. Prompt them with questions such as: What can you eat? Can you still buy your favourite brand of clothes? Do you still have access to the same games and movies?
- Students could research how the Chinese made silk, and create a poster outlining the process.

Silk

Nobody knows exactly how silk was discovered. One story suggests it was discovered around 2600 BCE, when Empress Leizu was playing in the garden near some mulberry bushes. Some small caterpillars were eating the mulberry leaves, and a cocoon dropped into a bowl of hot water. A fine silk thread unwound from the cocoon. The empress was so fascinated by it that she learned to weave the strands together to make silk.

At first, silk was only for the emperor and his most prized subjects. Because it was connected to royalty, silk became very popular. Huge fields of mulberry trees were planted so more silk could be produced. The silk threads were harvested and then woven into beautiful, silky material. The Chinese also invented **looms** to make their silk finer and more luxuriant.

As silk became more popular, it was produced on an enormous scale. By around 110 BCE, the Chinese government had 5 million rolls of silk in reserve. The emperors had so much silk that they sometimes used it to pay their soldiers. The Emperor Wu Ti (140 BCE–87 BCE) handed out more than a million pieces of silk to the soldiers who worked on the Great Wall of China.

 **1** Who is thought to have first discovered silk?

2 Who was silk used by when it was first discovered? Why?

3 What other thing did the Chinese invent to help them make silk?

4 How can we tell that silk became very popular?

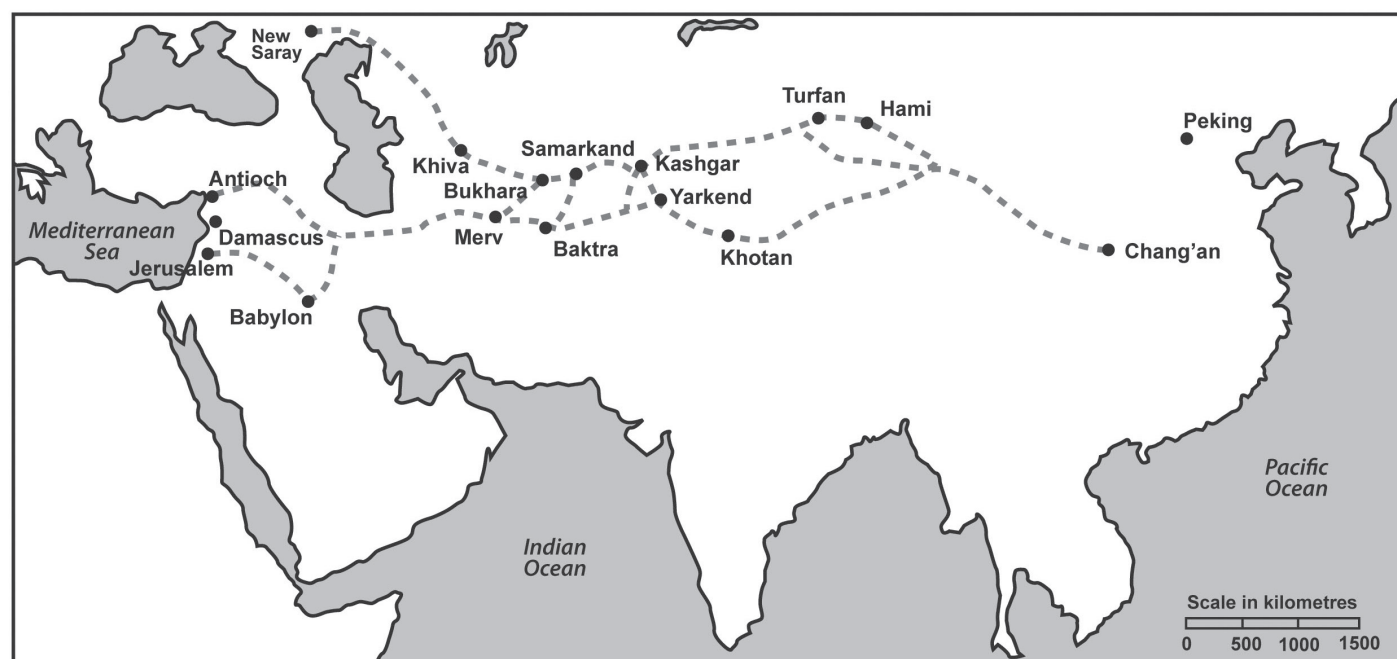
The Silk Road

Silk was one of the most important discoveries in ancient China. It led to the development of **trade** with other countries, who desperately wanted some silk to show how rich and powerful they were. The Romans and Greeks called China ‘the land of silk’.

Many Chinese merchants travelled west on camels. Camels were slow – they could only travel about five kilometres an hour – but they could carry about 180 kilograms of supplies and go for 17 days without water. The merchants travelled through difficult environments and conditions, including deserts, sandstorms and cold, dangerous mountain trails, where they were constantly under threat from **bandits**.

Because so many merchants were travelling along this road to sell silk, it became known as the Silk Road. The Chinese merchants traded silk for horses, foreign foods, jewels and rare animals and birds. During the Han Dynasty (206 BCE–220 CE) silk was so popular that a special government office was set up to control sales.

Because the merchants had to travel so far, silk was extremely **expensive**. Some westerners tried to get silkworms so they could make silk themselves, but the Chinese merchants were forbidden to reveal the secret of making silk. Anyone who told foreigners how to make silk would be tortured to death.



The Silk Road connected China to the countries in the west.

Maps and trading

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The Silk Road', then complete the following tasks.

1 What did the Greeks and Romans call China? Why?

2 What kind of people travelled on the Silk Road? What was their job?

3 Why were camels used to travel on the Silk Road?

4 Use the map on the Resource sheet to work out the distance between the following locations, and how long the journey would take. Suggest the best route to take and why.

a Chang'an to New Saray

b Chang'an to Jerusalem

5 Why did silk only come from China?

6 Why would merchants sell the silk, but not the silkworms?

Contacts and conflicts

China was often a very **isolated** country. It was surrounded on all sides by mountains, deserts and treacherous seas, which made it very difficult to travel in or out.

Despite this, an increase in trade led to quite a lot of contact between China and other countries, particularly Italy, where silk became an expensive but familiar item. The Chinese called Rome 'the other China' because of the similarities between them.

It was mostly merchants who travelled to and from China, including merchants from India, Persia, Japan and Korea who bought and sold Chinese products. However, many countries also sent **envoys**. Envoys were not trying to sell a product. Instead, they were trying to learn about the other country and develop a relationship with them. Eventually, so many foreigners travelled to China that they had to make laws stating whether foreigners could own land or marry Chinese women.

Sometimes the Chinese used trade and gifts to protect their country. A **nomadic** people called the Xiongu destroyed many areas of China. They invaded cities and towns, where they stole possessions and slaves, killed people and destroyed houses. The Chinese decided to give the Xiongu gifts such as farm tools and seeds, as well as silk, to make peace with them. Eventually the Xiongu stopped fighting the Chinese because they did not want to lose these gifts.

Trading with other countries

The ancient Chinese traded with many other countries. This gave them access to many new products, but it also led to a spread of ideas, religions, cultures and wealth.

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Contacts and conflicts,' and the Activity sheet, 'Maps and trading,' then complete the following activities.

- 1 Using an atlas, find China on the map below and colour it in yellow.
- 2 Find five countries that traded with China. Label each country and colour it in a different colour. These were not the only countries that traded with China, but they were some of the most important.

Hint: Persia is now called Iran.



- 3 Which countries do you think travelled to China via the Silk Road?

- 4 Which countries do you think travelled to China via the sea?

Objectives

- To learn about the background of one of the most famous Chinese emperors
- To develop an understanding of the impact that Qin Shi Huang had on China as we know it today
- To identify the beliefs and values that motivated many of Qin Shi Huang's actions

Prior knowledge

Students should be familiar with the information about dynasties and timelines in Unit 1.

Background

Qin Shi Huang is an important character in ancient Chinese history, famous for his accomplishments. These include positives, such as the unification of China and the construction of the Great Wall of China, but also negatives, such as book burning and the loss of life that accompanied the construction of the Great Wall. He is perhaps best known now for his tomb, which was excavated in the 1970s.

Starter activity

As a class, brainstorm the qualities that make a good leader. Which qualities are the most important? Discuss whether a leader in ancient times would have needed different characteristics to today's leaders.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Qin Shi Huang', introduces Qin Shi Huang and outlines how he united China. In the Activity sheet, 'The man who united China,' students complete sentences to consolidate their learning.

In the Activity sheet, 'Burial and terracotta warriors,' students match difficult terms with their definitions. Some students may need to refer to a dictionary when completing this activity.

The Activity sheet, 'Burning of the books,' presents a passage describing the book burning that happened during Qin Shi Huang's reign. Students insert antonyms for some of the words used throughout the passage.

The final Activity sheet, 'Great Wall of China,' introduces another of Qin Shi Huang's major accomplishments, encouraging students to consider both the advantages and disadvantages of such a construction.

Extension ideas

- When Qin Shi Huang died he was buried with many possessions. This was because the Chinese believed that people would need these in the afterlife. Ask students to list ten things they could not live without, explaining why they are so important.
- Students could make a table highlighting Qin Shi Huang's positive and negative characteristics. What made him a positive leader? What made him a negative leader? They could then conduct further research into his life and present this information in a poster or booklet. The following website may be of assistance:
www.travelchinaguide.com/attraction/shaanxi/xian/terra_cotta_army/qin_shihuang_1.htm
- Students could write a diary entry from the perspective of one of the Emperor's wives, describing her feelings when he died.
- Students could research some of the possessions found in Qin Shi Huang's tomb. See whc.unesco.org/en/list/441/andimperialtours.net/blog/terracotta-warriors

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Qin Shi Huang

Qin Shi Huang (259 BCE–210 BCE) is one of the most famous emperors in Chinese history. Although there were many emperors before him, Qin Shi Huang is often considered the first emperor of China. This is because he was the first to unite most of the country. The emperors before him ruled a much smaller area.

Qin Shi Huang was born around 259 BCE. He was called Prince Cheng at that time, and his father ruled the small kingdom of Qin/Ch'in. The Chou/Zhou Dynasty had gradually disintegrated into small kingdoms and states, and the rulers of these small kingdoms fought to take over neighbouring kingdoms. Prince Cheng was fourteen when he became the King of Qin. He spent the next twenty-five years fighting and taking control of all the other states. In the end he gained so much land and power that the remaining kingdoms **surrendered** to him.

Once King Cheng gained control of all the other states he changed his name to Shi Huang, which means 'first emperor'. 'Qin' refers to the name of his state. He was so powerful that the name of his small kingdom, Qin/Ch'in, became the name of the entire land – China. By calling himself Qin Shi Huang, he was calling himself the first emperor of all China. Shi Huang was convinced that his dynasty, the Qin Dynasty, was so powerful that it would last for ten thousand years. It lasted only fifteen.



Qin Shi Huang

The man who united China

 Read the Resource sheet 'Qin Shi Huang', then complete the following sentences by choosing the correct word from each word bank.

1 Qin Shi Huang was originally called Prince _____.

Cheng	Zhou	Xia
-------	------	-----

2 After the Chou/Zhou Dynasty disintegrated, there was much _____.

ancestor worship	fighting	celebrating
------------------	----------	-------------

3 The Qin dynasty lasted for _____ years.

fourteen	fifteen	ten thousand
----------	---------	--------------

4 Qin Shi Huang became the first emperor of China because he _____.

inherited the kingdom
fought the other states until they surrendered
believed his reign would last for ten thousand years

5 The Chou/Zhou Dynasty **disintegrated**. This means it _____.

collapsed	grew in power	gained more land
-----------	---------------	------------------

6 The name 'Shi Huang' means _____.

mighty Chinese emperor	first emperor	last emperor
------------------------	---------------	--------------

7 The states or kingdoms fought because they wanted to _____.

take control of the other kingdoms
prove their ability to become emperor
compete in a Chinese version of the Olympics

Burial and terracotta warriors

-  1 Read the passage below. Match each of the underlined words in the passage with its correct definition below.

Qin Shi Huang was very superstitious, and believed that potions and spells could be used to protect him. He was terrified of death – when he talked about his dynasty ruling for ten thousand years, he wanted to rule for that entire time. He often sought out elixirs that would help him live forever.

Although Qin Shi Huang hoped to live forever, he also planned for his death. As soon as he became emperor he arranged for work to begin on his burial tomb. It was enormous. There was room for 7000 terracotta warriors, 600 clay horses and 100 chariots, swords, bows, arrows and axes. His tomb was the size of about 50 football fields. He was not buried alone, either. All his wives who did not have sons were buried with him, alongside the workers who knew the secrets of his tomb.

There were 700 000 workers who helped build the tomb. They also put precious stones in the ceiling, and made the objects that were in his tomb. They believed that he would need all his possessions and wives in the afterlife.

- | | |
|-------|---|
| _____ | highly valued |
| _____ | soldiers or fighters |
| _____ | potions or medicines |
| _____ | a family of rulers |
| _____ | a grave for burial |
| _____ | believes in magic and mysterious connections between things |
| _____ | a reddish-brown clay |

- 2 List three things that were buried with Qin Shi Huang. Explain why these might have been useful in the afterlife.

- _____

- _____

- _____

Burning of the books

 1 Cai Lun wants to tell you something, but some of the words he has used mean the opposite to what he really means. These are called **antonyms**. For example, 'hate' is an antonym for 'love'. Help Cai Lun communicate his important message by crossing out the wrong words and inserting the correct antonyms from the word bank.

My name is Cai Lun. I am a scholar who lived during the reign of Emperor Qin Shi Huang. Everything was going (badly) _____ for scholars until the emperor decided that books were (safe) _____.

Some people say that the Emperor decided to (protect) _____ the books because a scholar stood up to him and (complimented) _____ him. There has been a call for books to be (cooled) _____.

Many scholars have tried to (show) _____ their books so that they do not lose them. It is such a (lovely) _____ thought that all our books might be destroyed. I cannot bear for such a thing to happen.

I am worried that if I do hide my books, I might be executed. I have heard that some people have been forced to do (soft) _____ labour at the Great Wall. The only books that are allowed to survive are those about Qin, (poison) _____ and agriculture.

Word bank

- insulted
- dangerous
- burned
- hide
- destroy
- hard
- well
- horrible
- medicine

2 What was happening to books and scholars in ancient China?

Great Wall of China

 **1** Use the words in the word bank to complete the following paragraphs.

Qin Shi Huang is also _____ for the Great Wall of China, which was created to protect China from the _____ tribes in the north. It was begun by Qin Shi Huang between 221–206 BCE. Until this time, the only walls that existed were made to protect _____ states. Qin Shi Huang ordered all these walls to be _____ together to make a wall that would protect all of China. The Great Wall of China still exists today, but most of what we see was built later, during the _____ (1368–1644 CE), although some older sections still remain.

Although the Great Wall was started during Qin Shi Huang's reign, it was not completed for several _____. The workers suffered under difficult conditions, working through freezing winters and burning _____. Up to one million people are believed to have died while working on it, and many were buried inside the _____.

The wall was mostly made of packed _____, which was piled up and then stamped on until it became strong and stiff. _____ were used to cover the packed earth inside.

When the Great Wall was first created it was around 2700 _____ long and between nine and twelve metres high. There are approximately 25 000 _____ on the wall. These allowed soldiers to watch the barbarians on the other side. The wall meant that _____ could be passed from one end of China to the other in only hours, using flags or signal fires to _____. It was also wide enough for an army of _____ to ride along it.

2 In your workbook, identify two positives and two negatives about building the Great Wall.

Word bank

Bricks
communicate
nomadic
Ming Dynasty
centuries
earth
summers
individual
wall
watchtowers
messages
chariots
connected
kilometres
famous

Your Achieve! History CD-ROM

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China 1 looks at the experiences of the ancient Chinese by exploring their occupations, lifestyles and family structures as well as law and order. Content also includes information about war and conflict, the life of Emperor Qin Shi Huang, women's lives, religion and trade. This text also provides students with an understanding of the importance of geography and land use in the creation of the Chinese civilisation. Historical and literacy skills are developed through the analysis of images and information, organising information in appropriate sections and becoming familiar with time and primary and secondary sources.

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- The ancient world – Egypt 1
- The ancient world – Rome 1
- The ancient world – Greece 1

Instant Lessons

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